

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6 5

♥ K Q

♦ 8 7 5 2

♣ Q 10 8 2

♠ Q 3

♥ 4 2

♦ K J 10 9 4

♣ 7 6 5 3



♠ J 10 9 8 2

♥ J 9 7 3

♦ A 6

♣ K 9

♠ A K 4

♥ A 10 8 6 5

♦ Q 3

♣ A J 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	1♥
All Pass			3NT
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠ J			

make the contract.

Just don't foul up on your ♠ entry.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ J.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=1 Total = 5

You need 4 more winners, and they will come from the ♦ suit once you have knocked out the ♦ A. But there is one danger to avoid - if the defenders don't take the ♦ A on the first round dummy won't have a ♦ to lead back to your hand. So to make sure you have an entry back you win the first trick with dummy's ♠ K, saving your ♠ Q.

Next start playing ♦ s, first ♦ Q, then ♦ K. Assume the defenders take their ♦ A on the second round.

Win whatever they now play and come to your hand with the ♠ Q to enjoy your three established ♦ s for 9 tricks total.

Establishing the ♦ s is the straightforward way to

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 2
 ♥ 7 3
 ♦ K 8 7 6 3
 ♣ 8 5 4

♠ 4
 ♥ K Q 10 6 5
 ♦ Q J 10 2
 ♣ K J 6



♠ A K J 9 5 3
 ♥ 4 2
 ♦ A 5
 ♣ A 9 2

♠ 8 7 6
 ♥ A J 9 8
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ Q 10 7 3

West	North	East	South
2 ♠	Pass	1 ♠	Pass
All Pass		4 ♠	
4 ♠ by East			
Lead: ♠6			

(pulling South's last trump), and discard a ♥ or ♣ loser on the ♦8.

You had to establish the ♦s to make 10 tricks. And once again you had to pay close attention to entries.

You were counting on West to have a little better hand than that! East is to play 4♠. South leads the ♠6, North plays ♠4.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 4

You must find a place for one of those losers and that will mean establishing the ♦ suit. If ♦s split 3-3 that will be pretty easy so you should plan to deal with a 4-2 split. Dummy entries are limited so win the first trick in your hand with the ♠A.

Before you pull any trumps you start on the ♦s by playing ♦A, ♦K and then ruffing a ♦ with the ♠K. South follows to the first two, then discards a ♥.

Play a small trump to dummy's ♠10 (North shows out) and ruff another ♦ with the ♠J.

Dummy's last ♦ is now good. Play a ♠ to the ♠Q,

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 4
 ♥ K 10 5 4
 ♦ J 10 9 5 3
 ♣ 10 5

♠ 8 5

♥ J 7 6 2

♦ 8 6

♣ A K Q 4 3



♠ Q 10 9 6 3

♥ Q 9

♦ K 4

♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A Q 7 2

♣ 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

have come up one trick short.

North's ♣ bid was Stayman, but he didn't match ♠s. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♦ J, East plays ♦ K.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 8

With the ♦ K onside you have 8 tricks, and only need one more. If ♣s split 3-3 you can get 2 extras and make an overtrick. But when you are missing 6 cards they are more likely to be 4-2 than 3-3. Since you only need 4 ♣ tricks you should establish the suit with a duck.

Win the ♦ A and play a small ♣ from each hand.

The defense gets a cheap trick in ♣s but you don't mind because you still have a small ♣ for an entry to dummy. You win whatever they return and take the rest of your winners, including 4 tricks in ♣s!

If you had played the ♣s from the top you would

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 7 2
 ♥ A 8 3
 ♦ A 9 6 4
 ♣ 9 2

♠ J 4
 ♥ K Q 9 5 4
 ♦ J 7 3
 ♣ Q 10 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5
 ♥ J 10
 ♦ 8 2
 ♣ A K 8 7 6 4 3

♠ Q 10 9 6 3
 ♥ 7 6 2
 ♦ K Q 10 5
 ♣ J

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥5			

West is to play 3NT. North leads the ♥5, South plays the ♥2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You are very lucky. Apparently North led from ♥ K Q so you won an undeserved ♥ trick. Now, if ♣s split 2-2 you can make 12 tricks! But hold it a minute. If you play dummy's two top ♣s and they **DON'T** split 2-2 you will only win two ♣ tricks and the contract will fail. Instead you should play a small ♣ from dummy right now. The defenders will win the trick easily, but you will win their return and you will still have a ♣ to get to dummy's 6 ♣ winners!

Ducking a ♣ is the only way to make the contract and you might as well do it at the second trick.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 8 3
 ♥ J 10 8 5
 ♦ K J
 ♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ A K 5

♥ A K 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A K 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 7 2

♥ Q 9 4

♦ Q 10 9

♣ J 10 7

♠ 9 6 4

♥ 7 3 2

♦ A 8 5 4 2

♣ 6 5

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 2

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ 2, West plays the ♠ J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners and dummy's ♦ suit is your only hope. **IF** ♦ s split 3-2 and **IF** the defenders don't take too many winners in their suit(s) you can establish ♦ s by ducking twice.

Win the first ♠. If you hold up they might pocket the ♠ trick and switch to another suit where you only have two stoppers.

Next play a small ♦ from each hand. Win the return (probably a ♠) and duck a second ♦.

If the defenders can only take 2 ♠ tricks now you are home-free since dummy's 3 ♦ s are now established.

You had to have the defender's ♠ s split 4-3. But in fact you were pretty sure they were going to do so. Since East's ♠ 2 was probably his fourth-down then he couldn't have a fifth-down.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 4
 ♥ K 10 9 8 3
 ♦ J 5 3
 ♣ Q 3

♠ J 9 8
 ♥ A 6 5
 ♦ Q 10 9 6
 ♣ K 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 6 3
 ♥ Q J
 ♦ A K 4 2
 ♣ A 10 6 4

♠ Q 10 5 2
 ♥ 7 4 2
 ♦ 8 7
 ♣ J 8 7 2

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠2			

West's 3♦ bid was a transfer to ♥s. East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 5

Obviously you need to establish 4 ♥ winners and by driving out the ♥A you can manage that handily. The problem is that dummy has only one sure entry, (the ♠A), and the defenders may be good enough to hold up their ♥A twice.

To assure the contract you should win the first trick in your hand with the ♠K. Then play ♥Q, ♥J overtaking with dummy's ♥K so you can continue establishing the suit while you still have that ♠ entry.

None of the other suits were sitting well so overtaking the ♥ was the way to go.